

March 17, 2026

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Occidental College

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Associate Professor (or Advanced Assistant Professor) position in Economics at Occidental College. I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, with research and teaching experience in applied microeconomics, financial economics, and quantitative methods. I am particularly drawn to Occidental's commitment to undergraduate teaching, mentorship, and community-engaged learning, and I would be excited to contribute as a teacher-scholar in this environment.

My teaching experience centers on making economic concepts both rigorous and accessible. As a teaching assistant for courses in data-driven and quantitative finance, I have worked closely with students to develop intuition for economic decision-making while building technical skills in data analysis and modeling. I am prepared to teach courses such as managerial economics, financial economics, and introductory courses, and I am especially interested in developing upper-level electives that connect economic theory to real-world applications in financial markets and policy. My goal in the classroom is to create an inclusive and engaging learning environment where students from diverse backgrounds can build confidence in analytical thinking and apply economics to meaningful questions.

My research focuses on household finance and inequality, combining economic theory with empirical analysis of micro and panel data. In my job market paper, I develop a quantitative model of wealth accumulation that incorporates heterogeneity in returns and income risk, generating insights into financial decision-making and inequality dynamics. I also work with longitudinal datasets such as the Health and Retirement Study to study how trust and financial behavior interact over time using econometric techniques suited to panel data and causal inference. This research agenda connects naturally to courses in financial economics and business-related fields, allowing me to bring current research insights into the classroom.

I am particularly excited about Occidental's emphasis on mentorship and student engagement. I would welcome the opportunity to work with students through independent studies, undergraduate research programs, and student-led organizations such as the Oxypreneurship Club and the Blyth Fund. I am committed to fostering equitable learning opportunities and supporting students from diverse backgrounds, and I value the role that a liberal arts environment plays in developing both analytical skills and broader intellectual curiosity.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would be honored to contribute to Occidental

College's mission as a teacher, mentor, and scholar.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards